

BUS105 | Business Communications

Course Texts

No need to track down a textbook; these texts are provided digitally as part of the course enrollment:

Author removed. (n.d.). *Business Communication for Success*. LibreTexts.

<https://open.lib.umn.edu/businesscommunication/>

Course Description

In this course, you will learn how to effectively communicate in a variety of business contexts, and across both traditional and new media conditions. Through a series of readings and assignments reflecting the needs of a 21st century workforce, you will develop an understanding of the importance of clear and concise communication skills, and their practical use in a diverse range of professional settings, including written, video, internet, and email modalities.

Learning Outcomes

After completing this course, students will be able to:

1. Explore how to effectively communicate in a 21st century workplace environment, and within a variety of business contexts.
2. Design a variety of business communication documents, including a yes/no email, persuasive business memo, résumé and mini professional profile, written cover-letter, and video cover letter/extended elevator pitch with a written communication self-reflection.
3. Formulate effective communication choices about tone, style, audience, and form; successfully implement these choices within a wide-range of business communications.
4. Create professionally compelling, multimodal content across a variety of traditional and new media.
5. Demonstrate effective business writing skills, including clarity, concision, and correctness.
6. Curate, analyze, and integrate credible research into business communications.
7. Demonstrate an awareness of business ethics, and the communicative choices that guide both ethical and logical decisions.
8. Apply communication strategies to understand intercultural and intergenerational communication, prejudice, and ethnocentrism.
9. Integrate appropriate formatting to business documents, including headings, design, documentation, and multimodal components.
10. Analyze business communication choices, reflecting on areas of strength and opportunities for growth.

Course Prerequisites

There are no prerequisites for Business Communications.

Academic Integrity Statement

Academic integrity is the pursuit of scholarly activity in an honest, truthful and responsible manner. Violations of academic integrity include, but are not limited to, plagiarism, cheating, fabrication and academic misconduct. Failure to comply with the Academic Integrity Policy can result in a failure and/or zero on the attempted assignment/examination, a removal from the course, disqualification to enroll in future courses, and/or revocation of an academic transcript.

Course Completion Policy

In order for a course to be considered complete, **all required coursework must be attempted, submitted, and graded.** Required coursework consists of graded assignments. Any Academic Integrity Policy violations may prevent a course from being considered complete.

Assessment Types

StraighterLine courses may include any combination of the assessment types described below. Review the descriptions to learn about each type, then review the Course Evaluation Criteria to understand how your learning will be measured in this course.

Benchmarks

Benchmarks test your mastery of course concepts. You have 3 attempts, and your highest score counts.

Note: Cumulative Benchmarks (final exams) only allow 1 attempt and use a browser-based examination integrity tool.

Capstones

Capstones are project-based assessments that help you apply concepts to real-world scenarios. You have 2 attempts, and your highest score counts.

Checkpoints

Checkpoints are quick knowledge checks on important course concepts. All are open-book, and most have 1-3 attempts.

AI Use-Case Policies

StraighterLine Capstone assessments operate under one of three AI Use-Case Policies. These designations are selected intentionally to support learners in developing digital literacy, ethical reasoning, and authentic communication skills. Each model requires students to engage meaningfully with the course outcomes while adhering to academic standards.

Independent Work Requirement: Capstones with this designation must be completed independently without using AI tools. The goal is for learners to showcase their own understanding and skills without AI assistance. Students are expected to generate and submit original work developed solely through their own reasoning and effort.

AI-Assisted Planning Option: Capstones with this designation may allow AI tools to support brainstorming and assessment planning. If allowed, students will be asked to document any AI assistance by noting how it

informed their work. Documentation must be included within the assignment or in a designated reflection field. Examples include describing how an AI tool helped organize an outline, generate ideas, or surface sources for further exploration.

AI-Integration Requirement: Capstones with this designation require AI tools as part of the learning process. Students will be asked to reflect upon their AI interactions and AI contributions to the assessment. Reflections must include which tools were used, how they were used, and what insights students gained from the process. This promotes transparency, ethical use, and metacognitive skill-building.

Course Evaluation Criteria

Your score provides a percentage score and letter grade for each course. A passing percentage is 70% or higher.

There are a total of 1000 points in the course:

Assessment	Points	Learning Outcomes
Checkpoint 1: Effective Business Communication	30	1
Checkpoint 2: Understanding Audience and Effective Business Writing	30	1
Checkpoint 3: Preparing to Write and Writing for a Purpose	30	1
Checkpoint 4: Revising and Polishing Process	30	1
Capstone 1: Yes/No Email	140	1-2, 4, 6-8
Capstone 2: Informational Report with Research	140	1-2, 4-8
Capstone 3: Persuasive Business Memo	140	1-2,4-8
Capstone 4: Résumé and Mini Professional Profile	140	1-4, 6-8
Capstone 5: Written Cover Letter	140	1,2, 4-8
Capstone 6: Video Cover Letter & Written Reflection	180	1-4, 6-9
Total	1000	

Course Roadmap

This roadmap provides an overview of the checkpoints and lessons covered in this course.

Checkpoint 1: Effective Business Communication

- Anticipation Activity: Effective Business Communication (Optional)
- Reading: Effective Business Communication
- Anticipation Activity: Delivering Your Message: Verbal and Nonverbal Communication (Optional)
- Reading: Delivering Your Message: Verbal and Nonverbal Communication

Checkpoint 2: Understanding Audience and Effective Business Writing

- Anticipation Activity: Understanding Your Audience (Optional)
- Reading: Understanding Your Audience
- Anticipation Activity: Effective Business Writing (Optional)

- Reading: Effective Business Writing

Checkpoint 3: Preparing to Write and Writing for Purpose

- Anticipation Activity: Writing Preparation (Optional)
- Reading: Writing Preparation
- Anticipation Activity: Writing (Optional)
- Reading: Writing
- Anticipation Activity: Answers

Checkpoint 4: Revising and Polishing Processes

- Anticipation Activity: Revising and Presenting Your Writing (Optional)
- Reading: Revising and Presenting Your Writing
- Anticipation Activity: Feedback in the Writing Process (Optional)
- Reading: Feedback in the Writing Process

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